police in all provinces of Pakistan, especially Punjab and KP. Turkish police arranged a number of courses in Pakistan and in Turkey for capacity building of police. Police, however, has the potential to perform better subject to commander's will and courage to lead from the front. Elite Police Punjab is a highly trained force that can face any sort of terrorist situation.

Police, being the most visible force, was worst hit by terrorists. Many policemen were killed in suicide bombing and gun and grenade attacks at the barricades, during raids and in their offices. For example, on 3 March 2009, six policemen were killed when terrorists attacked the Sri Lankan cricket team in Lahore; on 4 August 2010, Commandant Frontier Constabulary Safwat Ghayur was killed by a targeted suicide bomb blast at the Frontier Constabulary Chowk in Peshawar, when he was driving away from his office; on 9 January 2014, a Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP), Mohammed Aslam Khan, was killed in a bomb attack hours after his team shot dead three suspected militants in an encounter; on 23 October 2016, heavily armed militants wearing suicide vests stormed a police academy in Quetta, killing at least 61 policemen and wounding at least 117; on 13 February 2017, six policemen, including a Deputy Inspector General (DIG) of Police, Capt® Ahmad Mubin and Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) Zahid Gondal, were killed in a suicide attack in Lahore and on 18 October 2017, seven policemen were killed and 22 others were injured in a suicide blast in Quetta. In November 2017, DIG Hamid Shakeel and three police officials were killed in a suicide attack on Quetta airport road. A week later, SP Investigations Muhammad Ilyas, his wife, son and a brother were killed when terrorists riding motorcycles ambushed their vehicle in the Nawan Killi area of Quetta; in November 2017, Additional Inspector General (AIG) Headquarters Ashraf Noor was killed in a suicide blast targeting a police vehicle in Peshawar.

As Prof. Anatol Lieven observed, 'The Pakistani State, with its overstretched, demoralised and desperately underfunded police, just does not have the resources to defend against a threat on this scale'. Doubtlessly, efforts were made to revamp the police and enhance its capacity in all provinces. It had its impact but the result was much below the desired level. The efforts made in this regard in Punjab province were much better than in other provinces. Khyber Pakhtunkhwa police also showed notable improvement in its capacity to fight against terrorism.